

NORMANDY

THE BLOODY POCKET

D-DAY TO FALAISE 1944

Rules of Play

States of Siege™ Operational Series Volume 1

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INTRODUCTION

Normandy: The Bloody Pocket is the first volume in an intended sequence of games, *States of Siege™: Operational Series*. It is a solitaire game telling the story of the 1944 Normandy Campaign through its key events and decision points. The game begins with the D-Day invasion and proceeds as you, the German commander, attempt to stop the advance of four Allied Armies; all are bent on destroying the German Army in Normandy and thus liberating occupied France.

Historical Event Cards dictate the movement of the Allied armies and give the player a number of Actions to conduct each turn. The game is played through three chronological Event decks, and if you can hold the Falaise Gap space through to the end of the third deck you win!

GAME EQUIPMENT

Parts Inventory

- 1 Game Map
- 68 game pieces including various markers (Strength modifiers, Siege markers, Fortified Villages markers, Resource markers)
- 48 Event cards (24 grey, 12 blue, and 12 yellow)
- 1 Rules booklet
- 1 Playbook
- 1 Player Aid Card
- 1 six-sided Die

The Game Map



Text in shaded boxes, like this, provides the voice of the game's designer, who is addressing you to explain an idea or concept that is not, itself, a Rule or a Case.

The game map depicts the area of Normandy, plus a box representing those parts of Brittany, in which fighting occurred. The *Falaise Gap* space is the central hub of the game's activity and four coloured tracks emanate out from it.

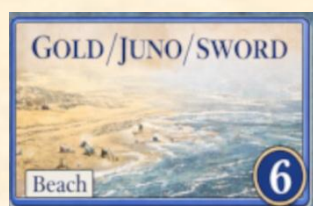
The spaces with "B" as a code represent bocage (hedgerow) country while spaces with "F" represent fortresses. "T" is for town spaces.

The two beach spaces, marked with "Beach", off the coast represent the five D-Day beaches: Utah, Omaha, Gold, Juno and Sword. They have been combined into two spaces; one where the American armies landed; the other where the British-Canadian armies invaded.

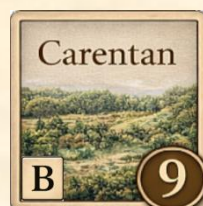
The beach spaces can only be counter-attacked on Turns 1 and 2.

Spaces with "H" are hill spaces.

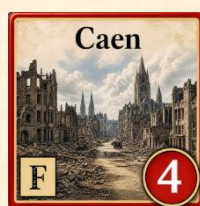
There are also various charts, and boxes for "In Transit" and "Strategic Reserve" units, a map key and three Resource Tracks for Transport, Supply and Hitler Approval.



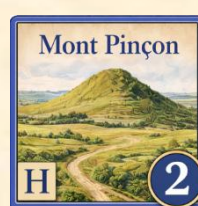
Beach Space



Bocage Space



Fortress Space



Hill Space



Town Space

Unlike most other games in the *States of Siege* series, all map spaces have an inherent defensive value (called *Terrain Value*).

(See the terrain key on the map).

The Four Boxes with Army designations are the starting points for those armies. Note that at the start of the game, British 1 Corps uses the 1st Canadian Army track (until the Canadian Army is activated by an event).

Event Cards

There are three decks of Event Cards indicated by the background color of the headline at the top: grey, blue and yellow. These cards reveal the game's narrative and drive the enemy forces against the player, also giving the number of actions available to the Player; listing available Allied air power, German reinforcements and resource level changes. The historical narrative for each card is listed in the Playbook.



Unlike many SoS games, historical text does not appear on the card (to save space). The card descriptions can be found in the Playbook.



WEATHER	
Die Roll	Effects
1	Overcast – No air power available +1 DRM for Supply, Transport Resource Rolls.
2–3	Partly Clear – 1 Jabo available; +1 DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)
4–6	Clear – all Jabos available; No DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)

CARPET BOMBING	
Die Roll	Effects
1–4	No Effect: Use +2 Carpet Bombing
5	Use +1 Carpet Bombing
6	Attack cancelled

SIEGE TABLE	
Die Roll	Effects
1	No Effect
2–3	Eliminate 1 combat step
4	Eliminate 2 combat steps
5	Eliminate 3 combat steps
6	Space captured

DRMs:

- -1 if defense-attack differential is >= 6
- -2 if defense-attack differential is >= 10
- -1 if no air power
- +1 if no combat steps in fortress

In Transit



Strategic Reserve



7

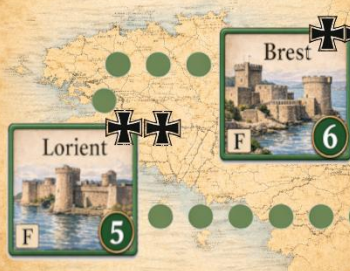
Eliminated Units



2

U.S. 3rd Army
Starts St. Malo/Rennes

BRITTANY



US VIII Corps Only



The map shows the Normandy invasion area. Key locations and units include:

- Cherbourg** (T, 7) and **Valognes** (B, 8) on the coast.
- Utah/Omaha Beach** (10) with an arrow pointing to the **U.S. 1st Army**.
- Carentan** (B, 9), **Tilly** (B, 4), **Mont Pinçon** (H, 2), **St-Lô** (B, 5), **Coutances** (B, 6), **Avranches** (B, 4), **Mortain** (B, 3), **Flers** (B, 2), **St Malo** (T, 7), **Rennes** (T, 4).
- U.S. 3rd Army** (2) moving from St. Malo/Rennes towards Avranches.
- U.S. VIII Corps** (2) and **U.S. XV Corps** (2) are shown near the coast.
- Brittany** section shows **Lorient** (F, 5) and **Brest** (F, 6) with US VIII Corps units.

Red circles with numbers 1, 2, 3, 5, 7 are placed on the map. Blue and green dotted lines indicate movement paths.

NORMANDY

THE BLOODY POCKET

D-DAY TO FALAISE 1944



SEQUENCE OF PLAY

Card Draw Phase

Weather Phase

Resources Phase

Military Phase

Action Phase

- Launch Counter-Attack
- Deploy Reinforcements to Map
- Redeploy Combat Units
- Refit Combat Units
- Increase Resources
- Fortify Villages (3)
- Move Actions to Reserve Box

Housekeeping Phase

MAP KEY

Defensive Value

	B Bocage	2/1
	T Town	1
	H Hill	2
	Beach	2
	F Fortress	4
	Fortified Villages	3
	Falaise Gap	1

6	6	6
5	5	5
4	4	4
3	3	3
2	2	2
1	1	1
0	0	0
Transport	Supply	Hitler Approval

SETTING UP THE GAME

Follow these steps to set up the game:

1. Place each of the three invading Allied Army units on their starting boxes (1st US Army; 2nd British Army; 1st Canadian Army).
2. Place the US VIII and US XV Corps markers in the 3rd US Army starting box next to St Malo. This army is inactive at the start of the game.

1st US Army begins the game with its “3” side face up; the two British-Canadian Corps begin the game on their “2” side. The two US Corps are “2” strength corps.
3. 21st Panzer, two Nebelwerfer and one 88mm FlaK unit begin in Bayeux
4. Two Nebelwerfer and one 88mm Flak Unit begin in Lebissey Wood
5. One 88mm Flak Unit begins in Carentan
6. Place the German resource markers as follows:
 - Place the Transport marker on the 5 box of the “Transport” track
 - Place the Hitler Approval marker on the 6 box of the “Hitler Approval” track
 - Place the Supply marker on the 4 box of the “Supply” track
7. Sort the cards into their three epochs (Early, Mid, Late). Set aside the Mid and Late decks for now.
8. Place all the other markers to the side of the board

Counters

The cardboard game pieces represent the four invading Allied Armies, one marker for each of the three resource tracks (Transport, Supply and Hitler Approval), and markers representing various military units (Allied fighter-bombers [*Jabos*], *Carpet Bombing* markers and pieces representing various German formations involved in the Normandy campaign.

There are also pieces representing Nebelwerfers (German rocket artillery) and FlaK 88mm anti-tank guns, *Siege* markers, *Fortified Villages* markets, and markers for *Patton*, *Montgomery* and *Model*.

There also DRM (Die Roll Modifier) and Attack/Defense Strength modifier markers which remind the player when DRMs should be applied to die rolls or modifiers applied to attacking or defending forces in battles.

Allied Armies



The armies represent the forces arrayed against the German army in Normandy. Armies start with a weaker “2” or “3” defense strength, but are flipped to their stronger “3” or “4” side by Card 28 *Upgrade Armies*.

US 3rd Army starts with its defense strength at “4”, but is broken down into its two corps; VIII and XV corps, as VIII Corps is diverted to Brittany.

The British 2nd Army is initially represented by its two component corps, XXX Corps and I Corps (both defense strength 2). When the Upgrade Armies (Card #28) is played, XXX Corps is flipped to become British 2nd Army and I Corps is flipped to become Canadian 1st Army as shown here:

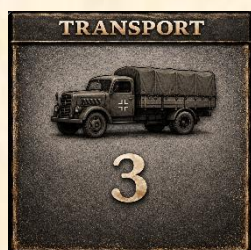




The Canadian 1st Army was activated on July 23rd; up to that point Canadian formations served under British command (1st Corps in British 2nd Army). To reflect this, initially the two attacking British-Canadian formations are XXX Corps and I Corps, even though the tracks are marked British 2nd Army and Canadian 1st Army.

Resource Track Markers

Transport



Hitler Approval



Supply



The three resource markers have a Base Level on their front. Transport and Supply Base Levels do not change but Hitler Approval Base Level changes to 4 following draw of Card #27 *Hitler Assassination*. This is the number the player needs to roll higher than to increase that resource's level on its respective track. This is called a Resource Roll.

Various game functions require rolling less than or equal to the current resource level appropriate for that function. This is called a Resource Check. For example, rolling to allow a Panzer division to redeploy from the map to the Strategic Reserve box, requires passing a Transport Check.

German units are considered to be abstractly present in every space on the board by the space's terrain value, but these forces can be augmented by panzer units, nebelwerfers and FlaK anti-tank units.

Once German panzer units take a loss in combat they are flipped to their reverse side; the next time they lose a strength point in combat they are eliminated.

Reduced (+1) Panzer Units can be withdrawn to the Strategic Reserve Box to be refitted (restored to full strength).

Panzer Units



Note that SS Panzer Divisions have black counters; Wehrmacht Panzer Divisions have blue counters. For example, here is 2nd Panzer division.

This has no effect on gameplay. Additionally, there are several “Kampfgruppen” (ad hoc battle groups) which come into play via event card later in the game.



Other German Combat Markers

Nebelwerfer



flaK 88 mm Anti-Tank



101st Tiger Battalion



Nebelwerfer units are eliminated if they take a loss.

Flak 88 units begin at +2 (Full Strength) and are flipped to +1 (Reduced Strength) when they take a loss. A further loss eliminates the unit.

These units provide a Defense Strength Modifier when present in a space being attacked by an Allied Army. Panzer units and Nebelwerfer units also provide an Attack Strength Modifier when attacking Allied Armies.

Michael Wittmann's 101st Tiger Battalion provides a one-off +3 Attack Strength Modifier when activated by the appropriate event card and is then removed from play (event card 9 *Michael Wittmann*)

Commanders

There are three commanders in the game, which are activated by event-card and provide Strength Modifiers (for that turn) for the units stipulated on the cards (Allies) or any German space in the case of Model.

Note that Model cannot be deployed until Card #38 *Model Takes Command* is drawn. If a card specifies Model as a resource for the player before that card has been drawn, ignore that reference.

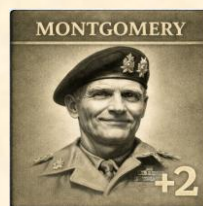
All Commanders' modifiers apply on defense **and** attack.

Model is allocated to a space in the Resources phase; Player's choice.

Patton



Montgomery



Model



Allied Air Power

Markers representing Allied Fighter Bombers ("Jabos") and Heavy Bombers used in a tactical role ("Carpet Bombing"). Each is deployed via Event Card and provides an Attack **and** Defense Strength modifier (in the case of Jabos), and an Attack Strength Modifier (in the case of Carpet Bombing), but is dependent on weather:

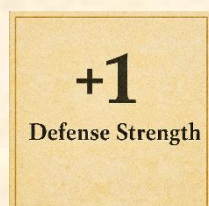
Jabos



Carpet Bombing



Other Markers



Attack and Defense Strength Modifier markers are used as a reminder of modifiers listed on the event cards. The Resource DRM markers are used as reminders for DRMs (listed on event cards) to the Resource Checks and Resource Rolls.

SEQUENCE OF PLAY

The full deck of cards enters play in three “epochs”: Grey - Early (Cards #1-24), Blue- Mid (#25-36) and Yellow - Late (#37-48)

Cards #1 and #2 are always the first two cards played at the start of every game.

Remove cards 1 and 2 and play those as the first two cards of the game. Then draw a card randomly for each subsequent turn.

The Mid and Late decks are shuffled in when the appropriate event card is revealed.

The sequence of play is as follows: -

1. **Event Phase.** Reveal the top card in the draw deck and place it, face up, on the discard pile. That card becomes the new Current Event Card that you must resolve that turn.
2. **Weather Phase.** Roll on the weather table to determine the weather; this will decide how much air power is available to the Allies and whether there are any DRMs on Supply/Transport Resource Rolls. Note, no weather roll is made when card #13 *The Great Storm* is drawn (weather is automatically overcast). Roll on Carpet Bombing table if required (i.e., when Carpet Bombing is listed on the card and the weather is not overcast)
3. **Resource Phase.** Place Jabos, Carpet Bombing, DRM/modifier markers. Adjust Changes to Resource Tracks. Add reinforcements to In Transit or Strategic Resource box.
4. **Military Phase.** Move all active Allied armies as indicated on the Current Event Card. If any Allied Army advances into the Falaise Gap (0) space, you immediately lose the game. Resolve combat between the advancing armies using the terrain value of the space being moved into plus strength modifiers for defending German units.
5. **Action Phase.** The Current Event Card confers a number of Actions to the player. These are used to: -
 - Launch counter-attacks against Allied Armies to push them back
 - Deploy Reinforcements from the In Transit box to the Strategic Reserve box and from the Strategic Reserve box to the map
 - Redeploy Panzer units to the Strategic Reserve box
 - Refit reduced Panzer Units (bring to full strength) residing in the Strategic Reserve box
 - Attempt to increase the resources on the resource tracks
 - Fortify Villages
 - Put 1 or 2 Actions into the Strategic Reserve Box
6. **Housekeeping Phase:** Remove all JABO, Carpet Bombing and DRM markers from the map.

A complete game continues until all the cards from all three decks have been revealed and played

RESOURCES PHASE

When each card is drawn, conduct the following:



- If the weather is overcast, place +1 DRM *Resource Roll* markers on the Transport and Supply tracks



- Place -1 or +1 DRM *Resource Check* markers on the Resource Tracks as listed on the Event Card
- Place Attack/Defense Strength modifiers for the Allied Armies as listed on the Event Card
- Place Commander markers deployed to the correct space as listed on the Event Card
- Place German Reinforcements in the *In Transit* (Panzer Divisions) or *Strategic Reserves* boxes or on the map (all others).
- Adjust Resource Levels according to the Event Card

D-Day Landings

The first two Event Cards of the Early Deck are the two D-Day landings cards. For card 1, roll a die for each of the three invading armies. If the result is greater than (>) 1, the British and Canadians successfully land on the Gold-Juno-Sword space (roll separately for each army).

If the result is greater than (>) 2, the US First Army successfully lands on Utah-Omaha beach.

Omaha-Utah tended to have stronger beach defenses than those in the British-Canadian sector, hence the higher terrain value

If an Allied Army lands on a beach on turn 1, the Germans get one opportunity to push that army back to its offshore box, after which it will re-land automatically on turn two and is then deemed to have a permanent lodgement.

The player, on Turn 1, with his one Action on turn 1 could:

Launch an attack against British 2nd Army from Bayeux, or against 1 Corps from Lebiesey Woods.

Launch an attack against US 1st Army from Carentan. Beach boxes have a terrain value of 2.

Note that the player only gets one Action on turn 1 so may not wish to make any attacks, since reinforcements are due to arrive.

If the player launches an attack against a beach box containing two units (1 British and 1 Canadian) he only attacks the Army of his own track and only that army is pushed back to the start box in the event the player wins the battle.

Example 1

The player rolls a 3 for 1st US Army and places the army marker in the Utah/Omaha beach box. Now the German player decides to use his one Action to counter-attack the beachhead. He decides not to use the Nebelwerfers in Carentan so it is a basic die roll against the US 1st Army defense strength of 3 plus 1 for terrain.

He needs to roll a 5 or 6. He rolls a 5 so the US 1st Army is forced back to its starting box.

On turn 2, the US 1st Army advances to the Utah/Omaha beach box without needing a die roll.

Note that if the player had not counter-attacked successfully, the US 1st Army advance would have meant it attacked Carentan.

i.e., any armies which fail to land on turn 1, automatically land on turn 2.

Example 2

Both British 2nd Army and 1st Corps have successfully landed at Gold-Juno-Sword beach. On his turn the player decides to launch a counter attack from Bayeux against British 2nd Army. Defense Strength is 3 + 2 for the beach. The Germans use 21st Panzer and two Nebelwerfer for a total DRM of +4. Any roll other than 1 will succeed.

The player wins the battle and British 2nd Army moves back to its offshore starting box. 1 Corps remains in the beach box. The German forces take no losses and remain in Bayeux.

On turn 2 the British 2nd Army advances to the Gold-Juno-Sword beach box without needing a roll.

Given the initial disposition of German formations, it would have been virtually impossible to throw all three Allied armies back in to the sea. Although see Optional Rule 11.1 which has two additional panzer divisions close to the coast to explore this option.

PLAYER ACTIONS

Reinforcements

Any [Panzer Division] reinforcements due must make a Transport Check (i.e., roll against the current Transport level). If the roll is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) the Transport level, the reinforcements reach Normandy and move in to the Strategic Reserve box where they await being released for deployment by Hitler. This roll (the Transport Check) does not cost an action.

Exception: Kampfgruppen/Nebelwerfer/Flak 88 units move directly to either the map or Strategic Reserve box. This costs no action (no rolls needed).

If the Transport Check fails, the reinforcements remain in the "In Transit" box.

Where there are reinforcements and a change in the Hitler Approval level, the reinforcement/deployment rolls come first; then the Hitler Approval level is increased/reduced.

During the Normandy campaign, Hitler maintained strict control over the release and deployment of the Panzer divisions; hence in the game, the player must pass a Hitler Approval roll in order to deploy, or re-deploy any panzer units.

Example

On Turn 1 Panzer Lehr and 12th SS Panzer are listed as reinforcements. The current Transport level is 5. For each of these formations, a roll of less than or equal to ($\leq$) 5 will move the units into the Strategic Reserve box. These reinforcement rolls do not cost an action.

Once in the reserve box, in order to now deploy these units on to the map, the player would have to spend an action to roll for Hitler Approval (currently 5). Since only one action is available on turn 1, only one of these two panzer formations could be deployed, and this would require a roll of less than or equal to ($\leq$) 5 on the Hitler Approval track.

Note that units in the In Transit box which pass the Transport Check and have moved to the Strategic Reserve Box can be deployed to the map for one Action (must pass Hitler Approval check) or they can be left in the Strategic Reserve Box for future deployment.

When deploying to the map, reinforcements can be placed in any German-controlled space, i.e. not in or behind the Allied Armies on their tracks.

Hitler Approval/Releasing Panzer Units

Once Panzer formations reach Normandy, they move to the Strategic Reserve box. If a Hitler roll is passed, the player may deploy the Panzer units to any German controlled space. The stacking limit is 4 panzer units, 3 Nebelwerfer, and 3 88mm FlaK Units per space. Kampfgruppen count as a panzer formation for stacking purposes.

Hitler Approval is increased by 1 for all successful attacks.

Hitler Approval is decreased by 1 for all unsuccessful defenses of a space where there are Panzer units (incl. Kampfgruppen) present.

Hitler approval rolls are made for all “Hitler Intervention” event cards. If the roll is passed (the die roll is less than ($<$) the Hitler Approval level, the Player may choose to not execute the Hitler intervention.

Hitler’s strict control of the Panzer units also extended to interference in their operational, and even tactical, deployment on occasion. A loss would enrage Hitler as he often accused Generals of misusing these valuable assets.

Supplies

If the Supply level reaches 0, no attacks may be launched involving Panzer units until the supply level is increased to at least one. Other attacks (not involving Panzer units) are unaffected.

Play Note: It will be quite rare for the player to attack an Allied army without Panzer formations being involved, at least in the early part of the game, due to the low odds of success.

One Supply Point is deducted from the supply track where any panzer units are involved in an attack, including 101st Tiger Battalion and Kampfgruppen.

Counter-Attacks

Any Allied Army may be attacked whether or not there are German formations adjacent to that space; the German units simply provide extra Attack Strength Modifiers and make the attack more likely to succeed.

The Player may attack with all, none or some of the combat units eligible to attack the adjacent space.

Prior to the attack, combat units may be moved to the attacked space from Strategic Reserve (which of course requires a Hitler Approval Check).

If the player attacks and wins, increase the Hitler Approval level by one.

For the attack to succeed the player must roll GREATER THAN the Allied Army Defense Strength.

The cost is 1 Supply Point (total) if any Panzer units (incl. Kampfgruppen and 101st Tiger Battalion) are involved in the attack.

Where German units are available, they add their Attack Strength Modifiers to the die roll for the attack. Flak 88 units cannot attack.

Where German formations involved in an attack fail to win a combat, take 1 loss: either one Panzer unit is flipped to its “1” side (or eliminated if already on the “1” side) or eliminate a nebelwerfer. Attacks involving one or more panzer units cost 1 Supply point in total.

If the attack fails, German units remain in their space.

If it succeeds, ALL participating combat unit must advance to the attacked space.

Exception never advance to beach spaces.

Allied Armies may only be attacked once per turn.

Example 1



The 3-Strength US 1st Army is in Carentan.

With no German Attack Strength Modifiers the Player would require a die roll GREATER THAN (>) 5 to cause the US Army to retreat (2 for the Bocage +3 for the Army).

Example 2



The 3-Strength US 1st Army is in Carentan. The 116th Panzer Division is in Valognes. A +1 (reduced) Panzer Lehr is in the Strategic Reserve box.

For one Action the Player attempts to redeploy Panzer Lehr from the Strategic Reserve box. He passes a Hitler Approval Check and moves Panzer Lehr to Valognes.

Now the Attack Strength Modifiers are +3 (+2 for 116th Panzer, +1 for Panzer Lehr). Defense Strength is 9 (as above). So, he's going to need a 3 or more.

The Player rolls a 1 (fails). He chooses to reduce 116th Panzer and both units remain in Valognes.

The Supply Points marker is moved down the Supply track by 1. Hitler Approval is unchanged. A defeat in a counter-attack does not affect Hitler Approval.

Redeploy/Refit Panzer Units, Move Other Units 1 Space

For one action, all units can move one space. This does not require a Transport Check. (Allows units left behind when Germans counter attack to “catch up” or units to retreat one space).

For one action, the player may move a panzer unit to the Strategic Reserve box. He must pass a Transport Check for the move to succeed.

Once there, these units can:

- Remain in the box
- Refit (reduced Panzer Units are restored to full strength); costs one Action
- Deploy back to map (must pass Hitler Approval Check); costs one Action

Panzer Divisions must be redeployed via the Strategic Reserve box. Kampfgruppen, Nebelwerfer and Flak88 units can never be redeployed. Where they are initially placed on the map is where they remain until eliminated (or moved one space, as described above). **Exception:** Kampfgruppen can be redeployed by *Hitler Intervention* Event Cards.

Refit allows reduced strength (+1) Panzer Divisions to be restored to full strength (+2); this does not apply to Kampfgruppen.

Units in a Fortress or Fortified Villages space under siege may not be redeployed out of that space while the siege continues, nor may units be deployed into the Siege space.

Sieges



If the difference between the total Defensive Strength of Caen, Lorient, Brest or a Fortified Villages space and the Allied Army Attack Strength is greater than or equal to 6, then a Siege is declared. Place a Siege marker in the fortress space.

Note that Sieges **never** apply to German counter-attacks into Fortresses (just use the defense strength as normal). In this situation, the exception that unmodified 6s are not a victory no longer applies.

Sieges only apply until captured by an Allied Army. Thereafter, if a Fortress space is recaptured by the Germans and then attacked by an Allied Army it is treated as a normal space with a 3 or 4 Terrain Value.

Each turn the Allied Army is designated to attack on a card, roll on the Siege Table.

SIEGE TABLE	
Die Roll	Effects
1–2	No Effect
3	Eliminate 1 combat step
4	Eliminate 2 combat steps
5	Eliminate 3 combat steps
6	Space captured

DRMs:

- -1 if defense-attack differential is ≥ 6
- -2 if defense-attack differential is ≥ 10
- -1 if no air power
- +1 if no combat steps in fortress

The -1 DRM for “No Air Power” means the attacking Allied Army has neither a Jabo nor Carpet Bombing marker attached to it.

If a modified 6 is rolled, all units in the fortress are eliminated and the Siege is over. Remove the Siege marker.

Units cannot be redeployed into or out of a space under siege.

Example (see diagram)

Caen is defended by two Panzer divisions, three Nebelwerfer units and one Flak88 unit. The British I Corps is attempting to advance from Lebisey Wood to Caen.

The Defense Strength is 4 (Fortress) + 4 (Panzer Units) + 2 (Nebelwerfers) + 1 (Flak 88) = 11. Attacking is the British I Corps with one Jabos (+1), and a +1 Attack Strength modifier for a total of 2.

Since the Allies cannot win this (Defense Strength – Attack Strength is 9), a siege is declared. A Siege marker is placed in the Caen space.

The difference is 9 so there will be a -1 DRM on the Siege Table roll. The player rolls a “5”, modified to a 4, so two German strength points are eliminated. The player chooses to eliminate two nebelwerfer units. The siege continues...



Siege of Caen

Resource Rolls

At a cost of one action, the player may attempt to improve the level of any of his three resources by making a *Resource Roll* (see Key Concepts)

If the weather is overcast (automatic when Card #13 *The Great Storm* is drawn), there is a +1 DRM to Transport and Supply Resource Rolls. These are the only DRMs that apply to Resource Rolls.

All the DRMs listed on the cards apply to Resource Checks, not Resource Rolls

Example

The player's current Supply Resource Level is 1 and his Supply Base Level is "3" (as shown on the Supply counter). The weather is clear (so no +1 DRM). A die roll GREATER THAN (>) 3 will result in the Supply level increasing to 2.

If the weather is overcast (+1 DRM), a roll > 2 will result in supply level increasing by 1.

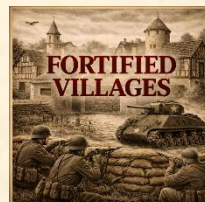
As many resource rolls may be made as desired per turn, subject to the number of actions available.

To a large degree, the ability of the German forces in France to move reinforcements and supplies within and to Normandy was affected by the availability of Allied Air Power. This rule reflects that. When the Allied aircraft were grounded due to adverse weather it was far easier to reinforce/move/supply the formations in Normandy.

Fortify Villages

For a cost of 3 actions, the player may fortify any space under German control (except the Falaise Gap space). The space becomes a *Fortified Villages* space (place the Fortified Villages marker on the space) and remains so until captured by an Allied Army. It follows all fortress rules, except that it has a defense strength of 3. It can be placed under siege as normal.

If a Fortified Village space is lost, remove the marker. The space reverts to its base type/terrain value.



This rule represents the German ability to fortify Normandy villages and towns, transforming stone buildings and ancient enclosed farms into strongpoints.

Put Actions into Strategic Reserve Box

The player may move 1 or 2 actions in the Strategic Reserve box for later use. There can only ever be a maximum of two actions in the box. It costs one Action per action moved to the SR Box. They can be used to "pay" the action cost of other actions when used later.



ALLIED ARMY MOVEMENT

During the Army Movement Phase, the Current Event card specifies which Armies must be moved along their respective tracks. Generally, these armies move a single box closer to the Falaise Gap (i.e., to the next consecutively lowered box). Occasionally, armies will retreat one space (i.e., further away from the Falaise Gap); usually as a result of a successful German attack,

the US Third Army begins the game inactive; it is activated automatically when the US First Army reaches the Avranches space.

Unlike most other States of Siege™ games, each and every space on the map has an inherent defensive terrain value. These are listed on the game board Map Key. For example, bocage “B” spaces have a terrain value of two, although this reduces to one when the Sherman Rhino event card is played.

Additionally, the intrinsic terrain values of the spaces can be augmented by the placement of German combat units: Panzer divisions, Nebelwerfer units, and FlaK 88mm anti-tank units. These units add a further combat DRM to the base defensive value.

The terrain values are as follows:

- [2] Beaches
- [1] Towns
- [2, later 1 for Allied attacks] Bocage
- [2] Hills
- [4] Fortresses: Caen/Brest/Lorient
- [3] Fortified Villages created by player
- [1] Falaise Gap

Allied Army Attacks

When an Allied unit is to advance into a space, carry out the following procedure.

1. Start with the Terrain Value of the space. Add the Defense Strength of any defending German units.

2. Total all Attack Strength modifiers of the attacking Allied army. These could be modifiers from cards, or modifiers from counters (Commanders, JABOS, Carpet Bombing).
3. Calculate the Attack Strength as the sum of the above two values
4. Roll the die. If the die roll plus the Attack Strength is GREATER THAN (>) the Defense Strength, the advance has succeeded and the Allied unit moves in to the defending space.

If on the other hand the modified die roll is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO (<=) the Defense Strength, the advancing unit is halted and simply remains in its current space; it does not advance.

Example

On Turn 3, the event card drawn is #14 *Operation Epsom*. The weather is overcast. The military section shows advances by 2nd British and 1st Canadian army so 2nd British will attack Bayeux (space 5 on the British 2nd Army track is a town with a Terrain Value of 1).

The Air Power section lists Jabos and Carpet Bombing but since the weather is overcast these are not available this turn.

Where the card says +1 Attack Strength 2nd BRIT, this means an additional +1 to the overall Attack Strength

Bayeux contains 21st Panzer (+2) plus two Nebelwerfer rocket units (+2) and one reduced strength Flak 88 (+1) giving a Defense Strength modifier of +5.

Total Attack Strength = 3 (+1 Attack Strength modifier listed on card, +2 Montgomery)
Total Defense Strength = 6 (1 for Bayeux plus 5 modifiers)

Allied Army must roll GREATER THAN Defense Strength [6] to advance, with +3 Attack Strength this becomes a 4 or higher.

Now the player rolls a 4

Total Attack Strength is 7. So, the Allies advance. German player takes one loss and retreats the remainder of his units one space to Tilly.

Note that a 1 always fails and a 6 always succeeds (exception; 6 does not automatically succeed for fortresses or fortified villages).

If the Attack Strength is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO (<=) Defense Strength – Attack fails, German defenders must still take 1 loss (but there is no advance)

If the Attack Strength > Defense Strength – Attack succeeds, German defenders must take 1 loss and retreat to next space on track. Allied Army advances into the attacked space.

See example:



British XXX Corps attacks 21st Panzer in Bayeux

Even if the German defenders hold off the Allied Advance, they still must take a loss. This simulates the gradual attrition and loss of combat cohesion of the German forces in Normandy.

Allied Air Power

The Allied Air Power available on a given turn is dependent on the weather.

The weather is determined when each card is drawn using the following turn:

- | | |
|-----|--|
| 1 | Overcast: No air power available |
| 2-4 | Partly Clear: 1 Jabo available; +1 DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable) |
| 5-6 | Clear: 2 Jabos available, no DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable) |

Overcast weather gives +1 DRM on Transport/Supply Resource Rolls; see *Resource Rolls*.

When Carpet Bombing is listed as an air asset, roll once on the Carpet Bombing table. The result applies to each Allied Army listed on the card to advance.

The carpet bombing table will determine if the carpet bombing has any negative effect on the attack due to "creep back" (friendly fire). Carpet bombing is allocated to each army listed on the Military section of the card. Some event cards do not have Carpet Bombing attacks so this rule will often be redundant.

The Carpet Bombing table is:

- | | |
|-----|---|
| 1-4 | No effect; use the +2 Carpet Bombing marker |
| 5 | Use the +1 Carpet Bombing marker |
| 6 | Carpet Bombing mission cancelled (remove Carpet Bombing marker) |

The Carpet bombing table, i.e., the use of strategic air assets for operational objectives in support of ground forces, reflects the ambivalent view held by ground forces, due to the nigh-inevitable friendly casualties caused by bombers dropping their ordnance short of the aiming point, either through error or "bomb creep".

Note Allied air power is only used for close air support of ground attacks; it is not used to defend armies against attack.

The effect of Allied Air Power on the interdiction of supplies and reinforcements was a major factor in the outcome of the Normandy campaign. This has been abstracted into the various losses of resources on the cards.

Example



Card 18 Operation Charnwood is drawn. The weather "3" so 1 Jabo is available.

This is allocated to the first Army listed in the Air Power section (1st Canadian Army) and there is a +1 DRM on the Carpet Bombing table.

A "4" is rolled, modified to 5, so a +1 Carpet Bombing marker is allocated to each of the two Armies listed on the Event Card.

German Defensive Units

There are four types of German defensive units which can appear on the board defending German controlled spaces: Panzer Divisions, Kampfgruppen, Nebelwerfer Rocket Artillery and FlaK 88mm anti-tank gun units.

All these units appear as reinforcements on the Event Cards (other than the forces which start on the map).

If German units successfully defend a space, they will always take 1 strength loss. The loss can be taken by eliminating a Nebelwerfer or Kampfgruppe Unit, or by reducing a Panzer Division or Flak 88 Unit from +2 to +1, or by eliminating a +1 Panzer Division/Flak 88 Unit.

If the German forces lose the combat and the Allied army advances in to that space, after taking a loss, all German units retreat one space.

The 101st Tiger Battalion represents Michael Wittman's formation and can be used as a one-off unit, either defending or attacking. Once involved in any combat it is removed from the game.

German Counter-Attacks

One of the key elements of the game is to occasionally attempt to force enemy Allied Armies to retreat.

In *Normandy: The Bloody Pocket*, certain units can add their combat strength modifiers to the attack, namely Panzer units and Nebelwerfer units.

There is a cost in supply of one supply point per attack in any attack involving Panzer units, including kampfsgruppen. It is not necessary to use German combat units in an attack; an Allied army can be attacked without such support, or the player can choose to attack with just nebelwerfer rocket units which cost no supply points.

If the player wins the combat, some, some or all of the panzer units/nebelwerfers can advance to the previously Allied occupied space. At least one unit must advance.

If the player loses the combat, he suffers one loss.

If the German Attack Strength plus a die roll is GREATER THAN the Allied Army Defense Strength (including any modifiers from cards) the German attackers take the space and force the Allied Army back one space.

Example

Bayeux has a Terrain Value of 1 and is defended by 2nd British Army (defense strength 3) giving a total defense strength of 4.

Panzer Lehr (+2) plus one Nebelwerfer unit (+1) attack the town giving an Attack Strength of 3.

A roll of 2 or more will give the Germans an Attack Strength GREATER THAN 4 and will win the battle.

The player rolls a "2" meaning the Germans re-take Bayeux from the British. The British 2nd Army retreats back to the Gold-Juno-Sword Beach space.

This attack costs the German player 1 supply point; additionally, has he lost, either Panzer Lehr would be reduced to its +1 side or the Nebelwerfer unit would have to have been eliminated.

Hitler Approval

The player must pass a "Hitler Approval Check" in order to perform the following actions:

- Deploy a Panzer Division from/to the Strategic Reserve box
- Avoid having to carry out "Hitler Interventions" as defined by several Event Cards.

The player rolls a die; if the result is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) the current Hitler Approval level the check has passed.

For "Hitler Intervention" cards, the player must fail the check for the intervention to go ahead, although he may choose to accept the intervention and not attempt the check. (Exception: the Card #32 *Mortain Counter Attack* always occurs; no check can be made).

For the “Mortain Counter Attack”, the start space (the Luttich space) is the space adjacent to US 1st Army. For this card, the attack is mandatory; the Player receives three additional actions once the attack is complete.

In addition to resource rolls by the player and changes indicated on the cards, the Hitler Approval level rises by one when a combat is won and drops by one when a combat is lost in which panzer units (not Kampfgruppen) are involved (defense only).

Additionally, the Hitler approval level drops by one when Caen is lost and by two when Brest or Lorient are lost (so -4 for losing both Brittany ports). This applies only the first time those spaces are lost.

in August 1944, Hitler ordered that Bret and Lorient be defended to the "last man and last bullet". The intent was to deny the Allies critical, deep-water port facilities to prevent them from supplying their armies.

Brittany: US 3rd Army Breakdown



US VIII and XV Corps Locations

Historically Brest held out until late September, and Lorient until the end of the war.

When the US 3rd activates its two corps begin in St Malo (VIII Corps) and Rennes (XIII Corps). When 3rd Army is listed to advance on a card, VIII Corps and XV Corps both advance.

VIII Corps attacks Brest and Lorient, XV Corps advances from Rennes. Each time a requirement to advance is shown on a card, advance **BOTH** corps. Any attack/defense/Air Power/Patton modifiers apply to both.

If VIII Corps arrives in the same space as XV corps, merge them into a single US 3rd Army marker (strength 4).

Loosing Brest or Lorient results in a -2 Hitler Approval Level (-2 for each port) the first time (only) these ports are lost.

Hitler's attitude toward the fortress ports in Brittany was one of absolute, uncompromising, and defensive intransigence, driven by his directive to hold them "to the last man, to the last cartridge". That is reflected here in the harsh penalties to the Player if they are lost.

Ignore the Upgrade Armies event for 3rd Army. It is always a 4 strength Army, or two 2-strength corps.

When US 1st Army arrives at Avranches, any US 3rd Army advances listed on the same card apply immediately.

Example



US 1st Army advances to Avranches, thus activating US 3rd Army.

VIII Corps and XV Corps are placed in the St. Malo and Rennes spaces respectively.

The Event Card is #47 *Red Ball Express* so US VIII Corps attacks Brest and XV Corps attacks Le Mans.



Sherman "Rhino" (Card # 26)

The reduction in Terrain Value from 2 to 1 applies to Allied attacks only. Allied Armies defending in Bocage continue to use the Terrain Value of 2.

Bradley Halt Order (Card # 42)

If US 3rd Army is split into its two corps, only retreat XV Corps (if it has reached Le Mans). Otherwise retreat the US 3rd Army marker.

Alencon Counter-Attack (Card # 46)

If there are no panzer units or kampfguppen on the board, or if 3rd Army has not yet been activated when this card is played, ignore its instructions.

Hitler Intervention Cards

When the player draws a *Hitler Intervention* card he may make a Hitler Approval roll. If the roll passes, ignore the card. *Exception: Card #32 Mortain Counter-Attack*

If not, the player must move the number of panzer divisions listed (according to the instructions on the card) and then attack the target given on the card. The redeployed panzer units **must** participate in the attack. These units can be moved from anywhere on that map and Strategic Reserve box at no [action] cost

The player may instead choose to implement the instructions on the card in which case no Hitler Approval Check is made.

If moving panzer units would break stacking rules, do not move the units, but attack with as many panzer units are in the space (up to supply limits). All nebelwerfer units in the space must attack in addition to designated panzer units.

No Transport Check is needed for this redeployment, but 1 supply point is expended for the attack as normal.

If a Hitler Intervention card calls for an attack on an Allied army besieging a Fortress or Fortified Village space, ignore the Hitler Intervention (since units cannot be redeployed into those spaces).

If the attack succeeds, increase Hitler Approval by one as for normal attacks. See example:



In this example, Card 36 was drawn. After the weather roll, the Canadian First Army gets a +1 from the Jabo marker. The Hitler Approval level is 2. The roll is a 3 so the Player must carry out an attack on the Canadian First Army in Lebisey Wood.

The Player redeploys 9th SS Panzer from the Strategic Reserve box and 116th Panzer from elsewhere on the map. One supply point is expended.

The Attack Strength is +5; the Defense Strength is 4. The player rolls a 2 resulting in a victory; the German forces advance to Lebisey Wood; the Canadian army retreats and the Hitler Approval level increases to 3.

Since the Hitler Intervention was carried out, the Player has no further actions this turn.

HOUSEKEEPING

During this Phase, certain procedural steps are performed in the order listed below before either the game ends or is continued to the next turn.

German Defeat

- 1) If an Allied unit occupies the 0 space on its track – OR – Hitler Approval has reached -2 the game ends immediately in defeat.
- 2) If on drawing Card #20 Caen and Avranches are both Allied controlled the game ends immediately in a German defeat.

This is intended to prevent the tactic of withdrawing to the Falaise area and building a hedgehog defense around the gap which was not tenable historically (not least because Hitler would never have allowed a retreat on this scale)

Refresh the Map. Remove all Strength Modifier markers and set aside.

Victory

The German player loses if any Allied Armies reach space 0 (Falaise) before the completion of the last turn. He also loses if Caen and Avranches are Allied controller when Card 20 is played, or if Hitler Approval reaches -2.

Obviously card #20 (Operation Goodwood) could be drawn early and this victory condition becomes nullified but as long as it hasn't been drawn the Player must defend these locations at all cost (as ordered by Hitler).

FALAISE GAP SCENARIO

This learning scenario gives a quick game which can be used to learn the core concepts in the game. It uses only the third deck of cards. With only 12 cards, it is playable in about 30 minutes.

Follow these steps to set up the game:

1. Place the 1st US Army (strength 4) in the Mortain (3) space.
 2. Place the 3rd US Army (strength 4) in the Le Mans (3) space.
 3. Place the 2nd British Army (strength 3) in the Mont Pinçon (2) space.
 4. Place the 1st Canadian Army (strength 3) in the Bourguébus Ridge (2) space.
- Reinforcements are at level “3”
 - Hitler Approval is at level “3” (Base Level is 4, Assassination Attempt has occurred)
 - Supply is at level “2”

German Start Forces

1. Place one full strength 88mm FlaK in Vire
2. Place 2nd Panzer Division (reduced) plus one full strength 88mm FlaK in Falaise
3. Place 1st SS Panzer Division (reduced) in Chambois
4. Place two Nebelwerfer units in Argentan

Bocage terrain value is 1. Model cannot be placed on the map until Card 38 *Model Takes Command* is drawn.

Shuffle the Late Deck and place in the Draw Pile.



Optional Rules

1. This rules supposes the Germans had followed Rommel's advice to position Panzer forces near the coast. Panzer Lehr starts the game in Carentan; 12SS Panzer starts in Lebisey Wood.